

Once you understand what it means for a scenario to be **impossible**, you can understand what it means for a situation to be **necessary**: a situation is necessary just in case its opposite is impossible.

Here are some examples of things which seem to be necessary.

possible

necessary

contingent

Every three-sided plane
closed Euclidean figure has
three angles.

If Alfred is taller than
Sam, then Sam is
shorter than Alfred.

There are no objects which are bright
red and bright green all over.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



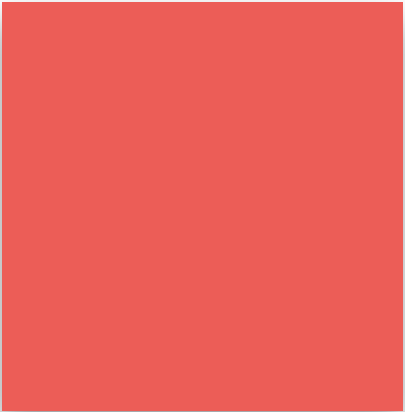
objections
to the
PSR

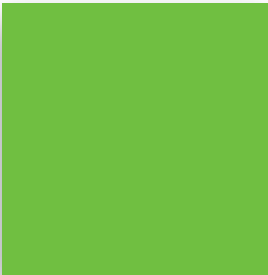
needed any just in case it's opposite is impossible.

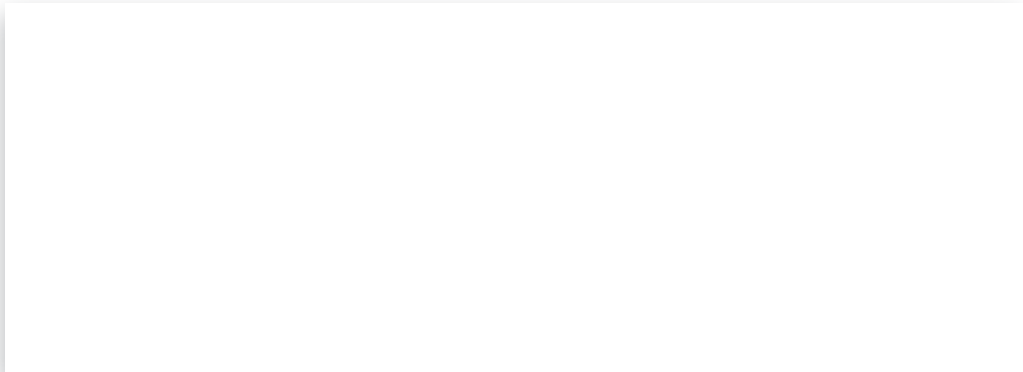
Once you understand what it means for a scenario to be impossible, you

can understand what it means for a situation to be necessary: a situation is





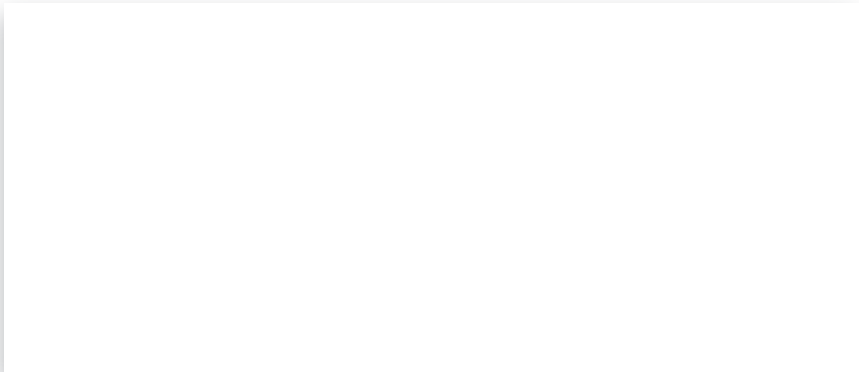




there are angles.

closed Euclidean figures has

Every three-sided plane



If Alfred is taller than

shorter than Alfred.

Sam, then Sam is



There are no objects which are bright

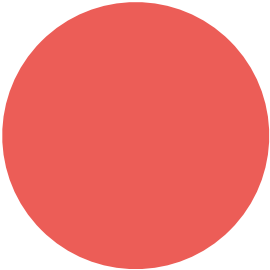
red and bright green all over.

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

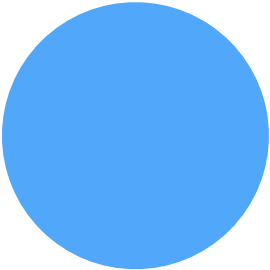
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.







objections
to the
PSR





Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to



Leibniz's
argument

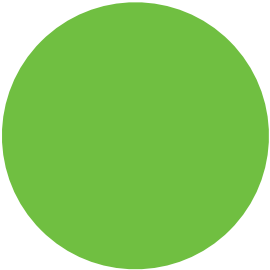


the
PSR





Leibniz's
argument



possible

